Spotlight, Eurovision

About three minutes, spoken freely. The first line in italics is a cue for each slide and is not read out.

Slide 1, title

neighbours, every May

Every May millions of people watch the Eurovision votes come in while somebody says they only vote for their neighbours. We wanted to know how much of that is actually true.

Slide 2, Greece to Cyprus

eight finals, eight times twelve

Since 2016 Cyprus has made it to the final eight times. Every single time, the Greek public gave it twelve points. So was that the song or was that Greece? As a fan you can't tell. The people who send the songs can't either.

Slide 3, juries and public

every country votes twice

It gets more confusing because every country votes twice, once with a jury and once with the public. Every dot here is one song in a final. If both agreed, the dots would sit on the line. Israel in 2024 got about fifty points from the juries and more than three hundred from the public. Switzerland in 2025 got over two hundred from the juries and nothing at all from the public.

Slide 4, song or neighbours

split every vote in two

So we took every vote in the ten finals since 2016 and split it in two. One part is the song, measured by how it did with everybody else. The other part is the neighbours, so things like distance, language and how two countries voted for each other before. We always checked this on finals our method had not seen. For the juries the song explains a quarter of a vote and the neighbours about three percent. For the public it's forty percent for the song and twelve and a half for the neighbours. That is more than four times as much.

Slide 5, Greece in 2024

one country, two lists

Here is one ballot, Greece in 2024. The Greek jury gave its twelve points to Switzerland and put Cyprus second. The Greek public gave its twelve to Cyprus again. Israel got seven points from the Greek public and nothing from the jury.

Slide 6, who it is for

fans and delegations

For fans this puts real numbers on the oldest argument of the contest. For a delegation it shows which part of a result it can change with the song and which part comes from neighbours and diaspora. Thank you.